

Breath-Exchange Strengthening

吐纳换气强身法

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FIGURES 21–22

Follow each panel left to right.



inhale



exhale



voiced
release

One continuous practice: Opening → Push Qi → Divide Qi → Scoop Qi → Closing.

OPENING · 起势

21



Exchange

three long exhale–inhale cycles

Stand with feet together and arms relaxed at the sides. **Exhale slowly through the mouth** as if emptying stale air; then **inhale slowly through the nose** as if filling with fresh air.

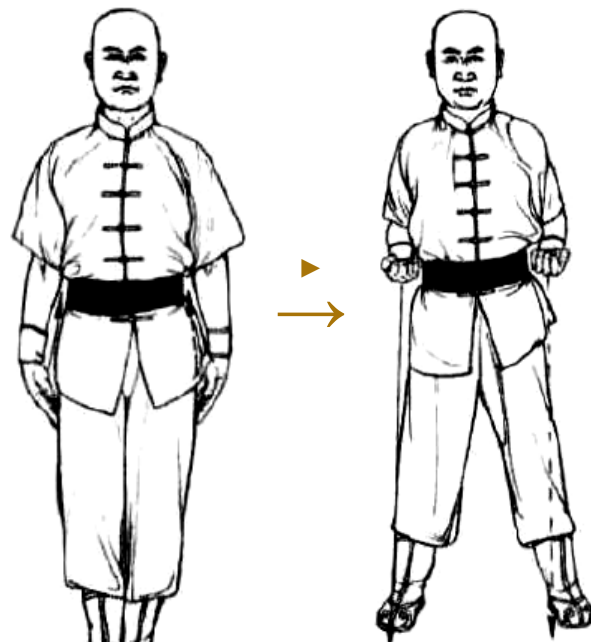
21

22

Set the stance

three inhale–exhale cycles

Step the left foot out slightly wider than shoulder-width, toes forward. Hold fists at the waist, **fist hearts up**. Once set, inhale first and then exhale.



Practise gradually in clean air. Do not train when very hungry, overly full, after alcohol, or exhausted.

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FIGURES 22-24

PUSH QI · 推气

Exhale

long · through the nose

Open the fists, rotate the palms inward, and reach toward the feet as the torso folds. Finish when the fingertips touch the ground; pause briefly.

22



23



23



24



Inhale

slow and deep

Extend the wrists, form claws, and press downward.

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FIGURES 24–26

Fill

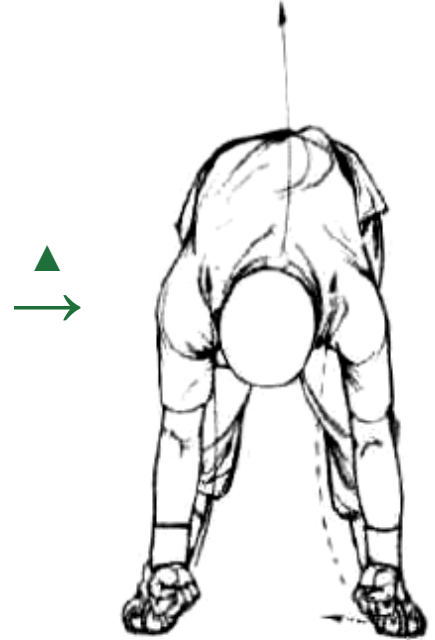
complete the same inhale

Curl the fingers into fists with the two fist hearts facing each other.

24



25



Exhale

long · rise with the breath

Lift the fists straight forward and upward as if raising a heavy object. Rise through the waist to shoulder height and draw the left foot in slightly.

25



26



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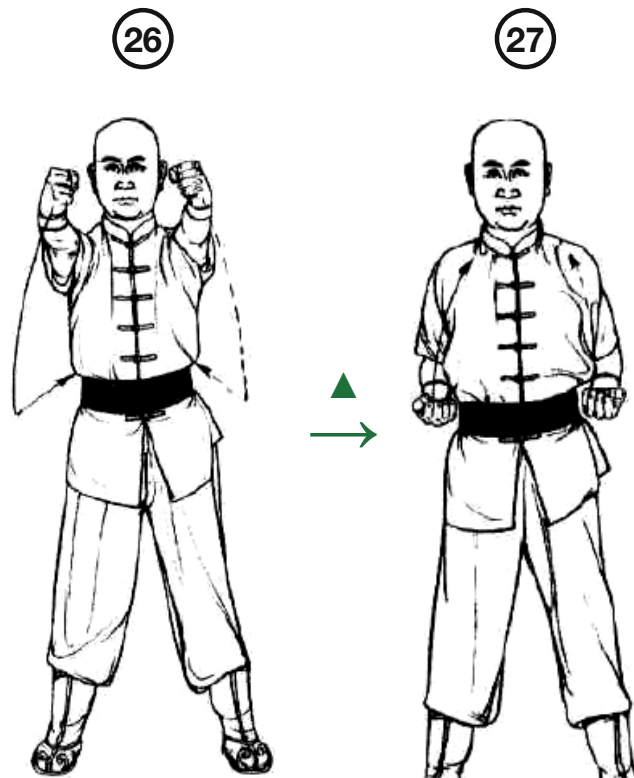
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FIGURES 26–28

Inhale

deep · through the nose

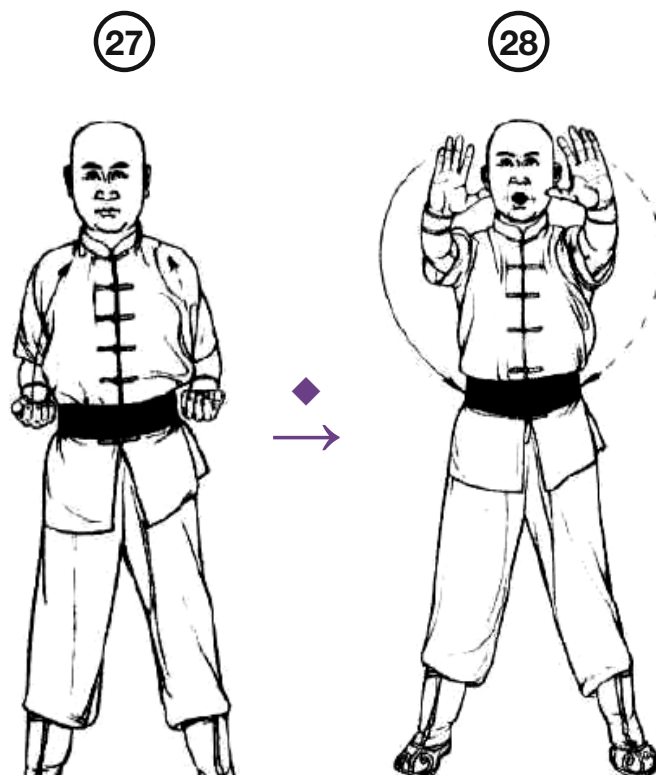
Draw both fists to the waist, **fist hearts up**.



Ha—

forceful voiced exhale

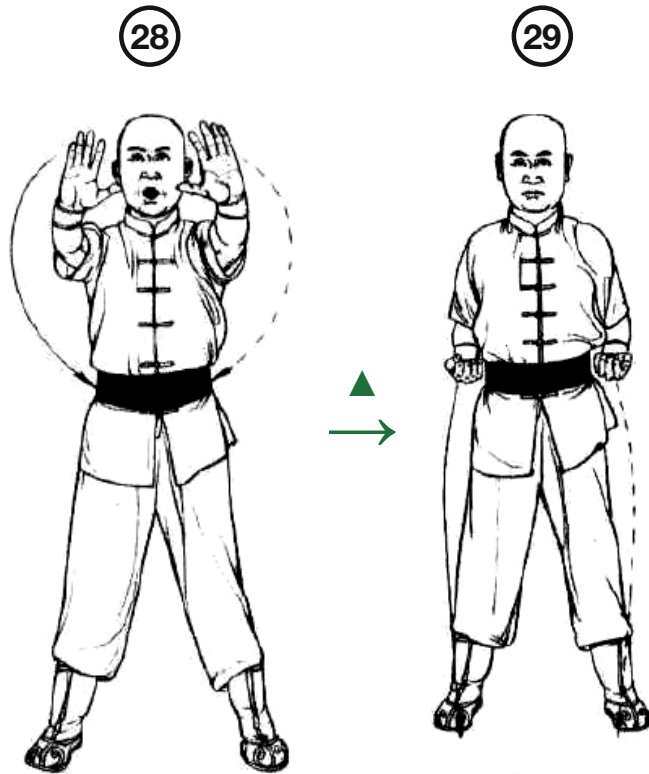
Open the fists and thrust both palms straight forward at shoulder height —**palms forward, fingertips up**.



Recover

pause, then inhale deeply

Make fists and bend the elbows, returning the fists to the waist.

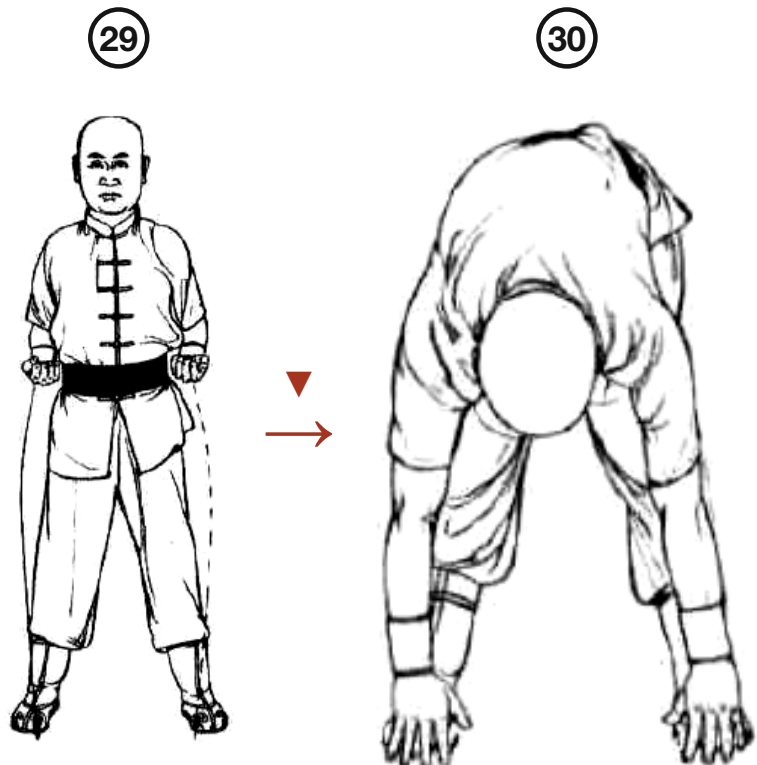


DIVIDE QI · 分气

Exhale

long · through the nose

Open the fists, rotate the palms inward, reach down until the fingertips touch the ground, and fold the torso.



Inhale

deep · through the nose

Extend the wrists, form claws, and press downward.

30



31



31



32



Continue

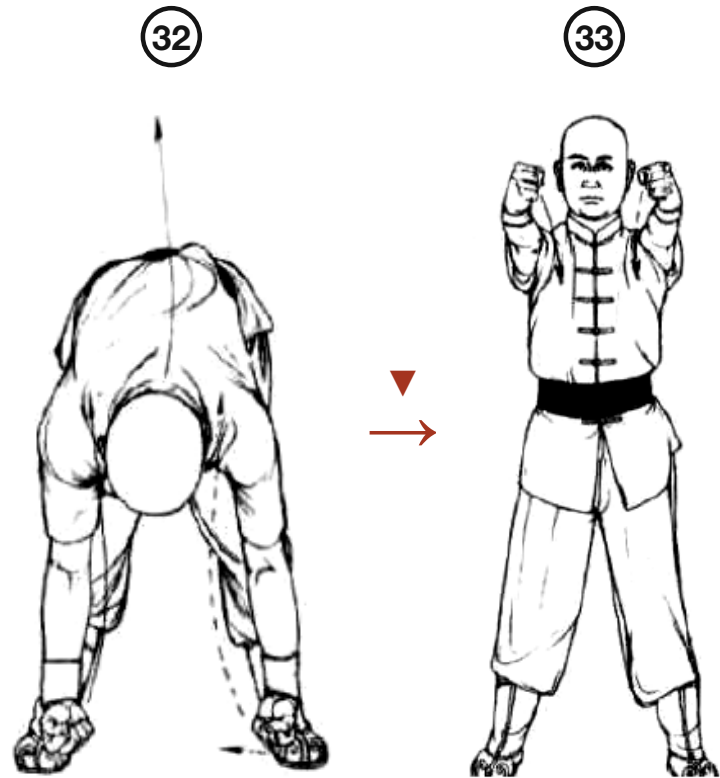
the same inhale

Curl the fingers into fists with the two fist hearts facing each other.

Exhale

long · rise with the breath

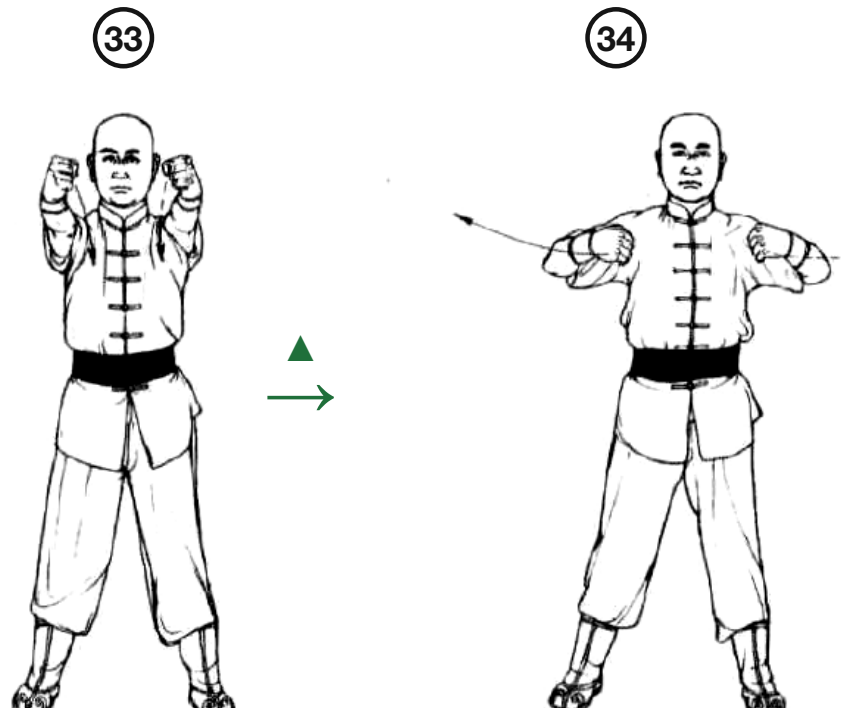
Lift the fists like a heavy object to shoulder height. Straighten the upper body and draw the left foot in slightly.



Inhale

deep · through the nose

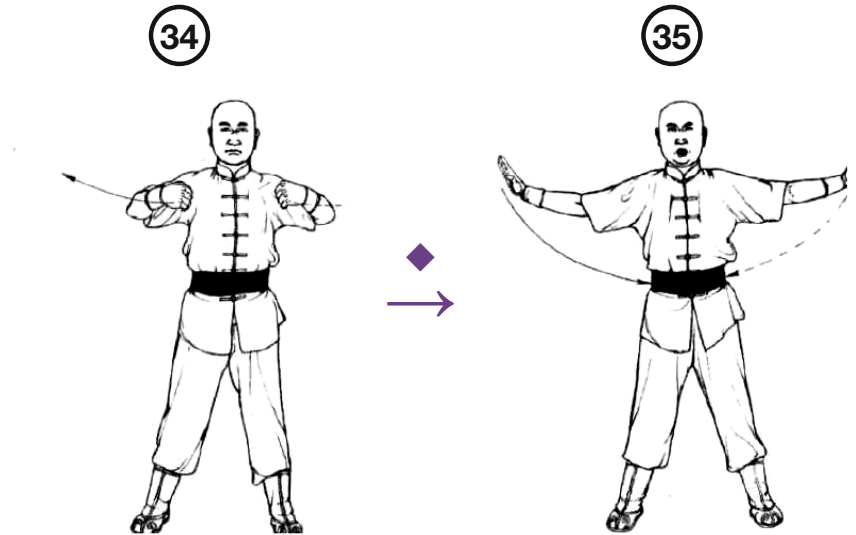
Bend the elbows and draw the fists back before the shoulders—**knuckles facing, fist hearts inward.**



Ha—

forceful voiced exhale

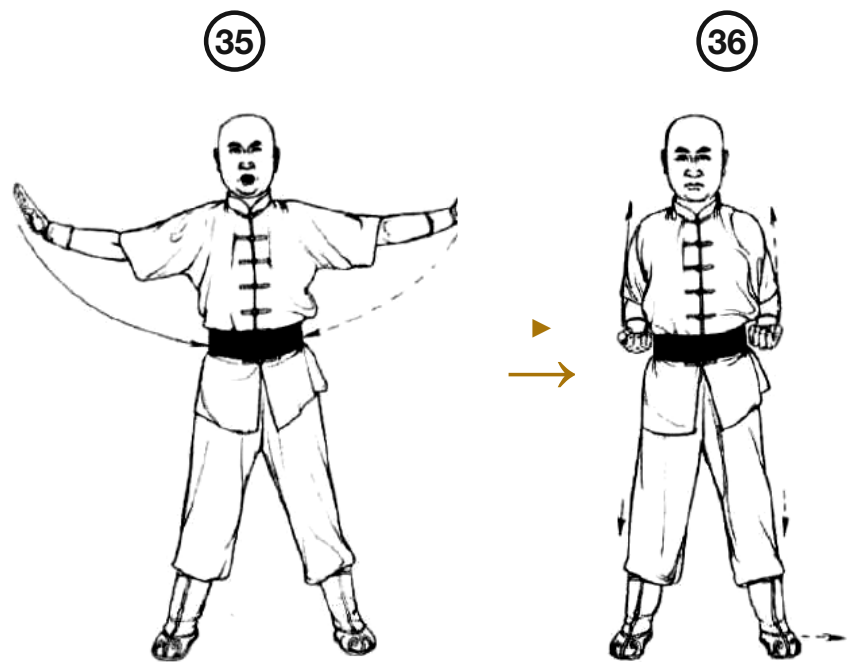
Open both fists and drive the palms outward to the left and right at shoulder height, **palms facing out**.



Gather

inhale, then exhale once set

Rotate the hands outward, make fists, and draw them to the waist, **fist hearts up**. Once the posture is set, exhale through the nose.



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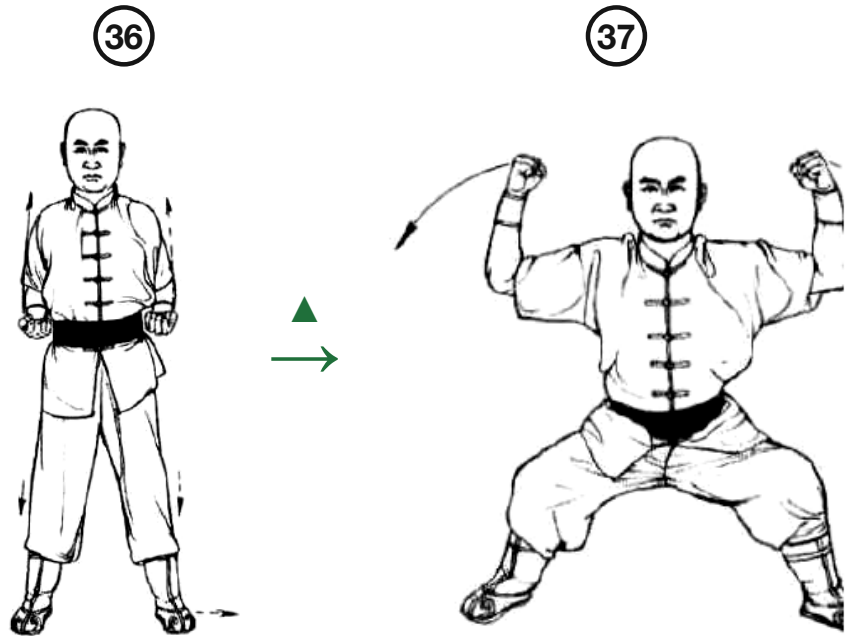
FIGURES 36–38

SCOOP QI · 捞气

Inhale

deep · through the nose

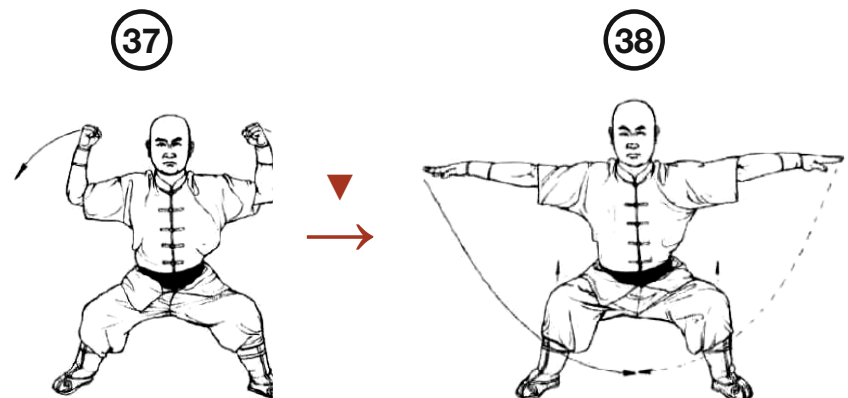
Step the left foot half a step outward and sink into horse stance. As you descend, bend the elbows and raise the fists near forehead height in a “mountain” shape, fist hearts facing.



Exhale

long · through the nose

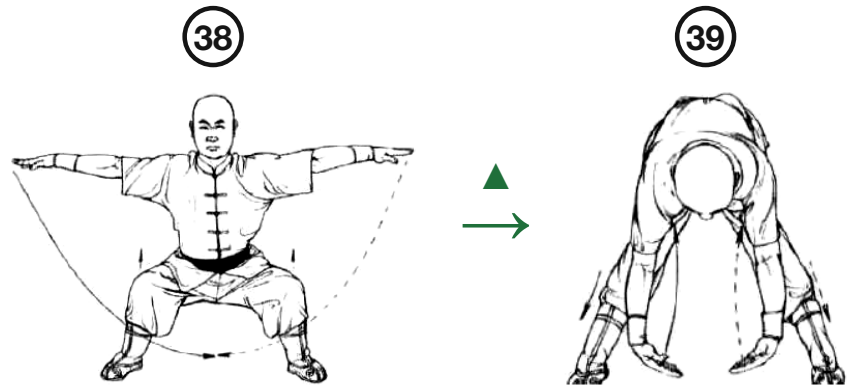
Open the fists and extend both arms to the sides at shoulder height, **palms down**.



Inhale

deep • begin the scoop

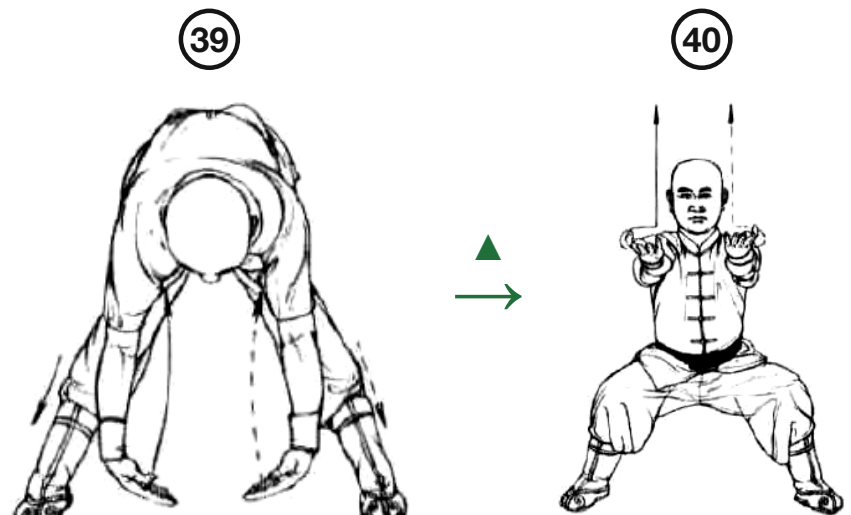
Lower the hands as the torso folds and the legs gradually straighten. Near knee height, turn the palms inward and scoop them together, **palms up**.



Continue

the same inhale

When the hands are about shoulder-width apart, carry them forward and upward. Rise through the torso while the hips sink back into horse stance.



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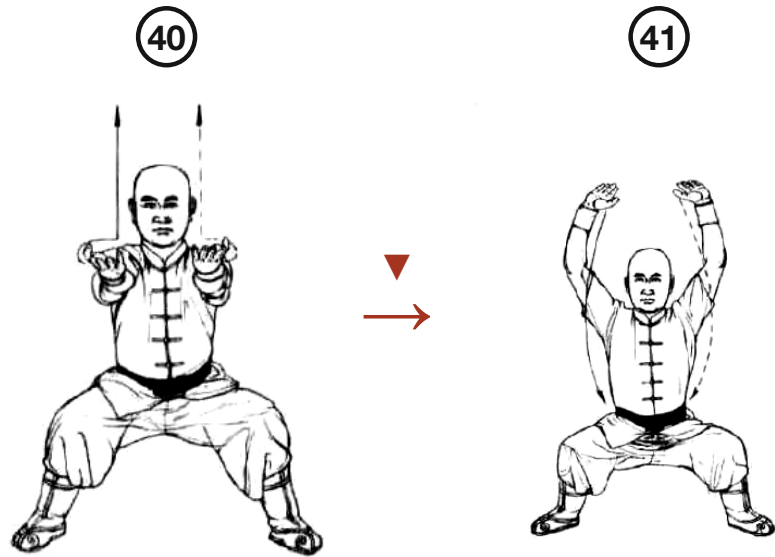
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FIGURES 40–42

Exhale

long · through the nose

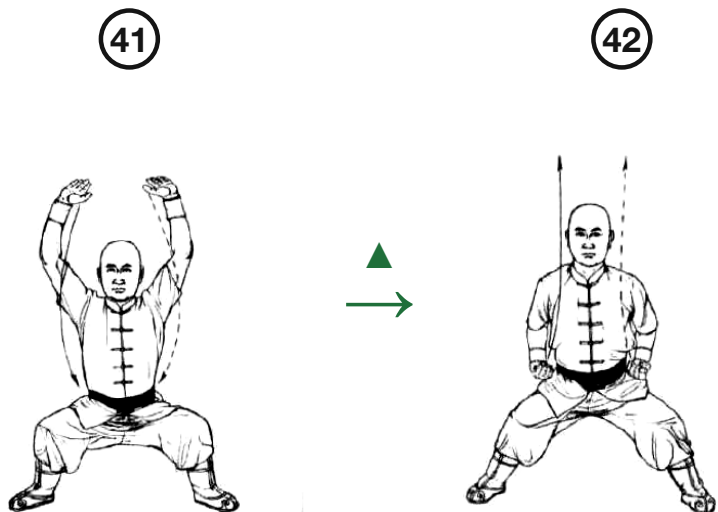
Rotate the palms outward and lift them over the crown—**fingertips back, palms up**.



Inhale

deep · through the nose

Make fists and lower them to the waist.



Practise gradually in clean air. Do not train when very hungry, overly full, after alcohol, or exhausted.

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FIGURES 42–44

Ha—

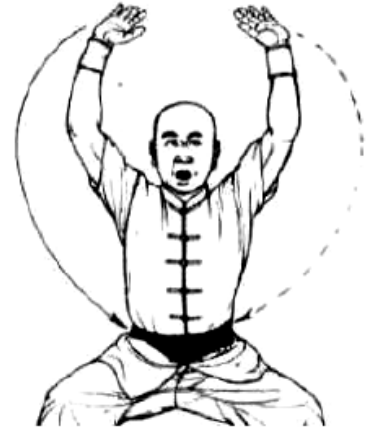
forceful voiced exhale

Open the fists and drive both palms upward—**palms up, fingertips pointing back.**

42



43

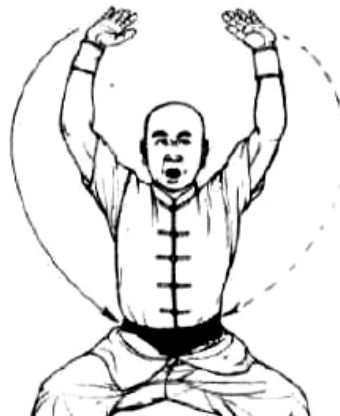


Recover

deep • through the nose

Make fists, bend the elbows, and lower the hands to the waist. Once set, breathe in this stance for several cycles; weaker practitioners may close directly.

43



44

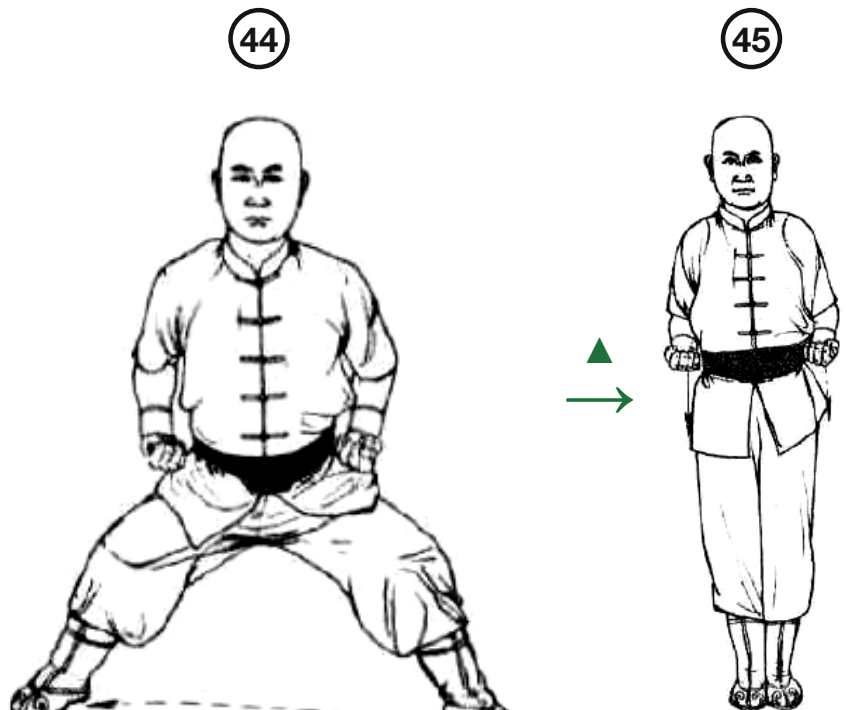


CLOSING · 收势

Inhale

deep · through the nose

Draw the left foot inward to meet the right and stand upright with the fists still held at the waist.



Close

long · then regulate the breath

Open the fists, let the hands fall to the sides, relax the whole body, and allow the breathing to become even.

